HEXLEY CHEMICALS

Statement Guide: Housekeeping and Waste

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1. What this guide covers

This guide covers housekeeping and waste: keeping the work area tidy and the walkways clear, and taking waste away - rags, swarf and rod stubs, residues and sludge, lagging and cladding, spoil and contaminated water. It appears in method statements for every permit type, at the end of the work most of all.

The guide is used by the Permit Coordinator or Area Authority who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Area Authority who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the request and its permit type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a gas reading that differs from the request's, as the Permit Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- the work area left clean and tidy at hand-back
- tools and materials kept off walkways
- oily rags in a metal bin, and swarf and rod stubs collected
- residues, sludge and waste lagging bagged, drummed and labelled for disposal
- spoil kept back from the edge, and contaminated water kept out of the surface drains

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the permit type and the work activity, and the waste the job will make.
2 Read each sentence of this kind for how the area is kept and the waste taken away.
3 Check waste that could burn is kept away from hot work.
4 Note waste the job will make that no sentence deals with.
5 Check the area is left clean at hand-back.

4. Requirements it bears on

Housekeeping and waste bear on no requirement of any permit standard. A tidy area supports the requirements - spoil kept back from a dig's edge, combustible waste away from hot work - but the request's answers decide them.

5. When the statement and the request disagree

A statement about housekeeping cannot disagree with the request, which records no answer about it; the reviewer notes waste that is not dealt with for the Area Authority.

6. What to ask the requester for

Ask the performing authority how the waste the job makes will be collected, labelled and taken away, and how the area will be left at hand-back.

7. Telling it apart

Keeping the area tidy and taking waste away is housekeeping and waste; clearing what can burn from around hot work, the fire watch and the extinguishers are fire precautions, which the Fire Precautions guide covers. "Welding rod stubs are collected in a tin" is housekeeping; "everything that can burn is moved back from the work point" is a fire precaution.